

Austin Sonny Stethem

Relocating to Saint Paul, MN | austin-stethem.github.io | [LinkedIn](#) | 712-299-5267 | austinstethem1976@gmail.com

Executive Summary

Reporting directly to the VP and Senior Managing Partner, I operate near completely autonomously to manage the cost architecture and **Master Data (MDM)** for a **multi-million SKU, 80-branch distribution network**. Driven by a genuine passion for process optimization, I proactively engineered the **SQL extractions** and **Python scenario models** that **forecast financial results, isolate product cost variances, and stop gross margin erosion before it hits the P&L**. I act as the strategic bridge between Finance and IT, successfully pitching systemic fixes directly to executive leadership. Because I control this data at its root, I partner cross-functionally with sales, procurement, and distribution teams to ensure clean metrics drive highly accurate, driver-based financial planning.

CORE COMPETENCIES

FP&A & Margin Strategy: Driver-Based Planning, Variance to Forecast, Gross Margin Defense, Price Waterfalls

Technical Analytics: SQL (Data Extraction), Python (Scenario Modeling), Advanced Excel (Power Query), Phocas BI

Master Data & Ops: ERP Cost Architecture, MDM Validation, SKU Lifecycles, POS Resolution

Leadership & Strategy: Executive Business Cases, Cross-Functional Alignment, Process Improvement

WORK EXPERIENCE

Merrill Company, Arnold Motor Supply

Spencer, Iowa

Inventory, Product, and Pricing Analyst

September 2021 – Present

- **Variance Analysis & BI Strategy:** Authored complex SQL queries to automate Phocas BI reporting, transitioning from manual audits to rolling 12-month variance models that proactively identify supplier cost issues and avoid gross margin erosion.
- **Scenario Modeling & Forecasting:** Developed Python-based Monte Carlo simulations to forecast supply chain margin risk and landed-cost volatility, increasing efficiency by shifting the enterprise toward accurate, driver-based financial planning.
- **Enterprise Cost Architecture:** Acted as one of three administrators governing master data across an 80-branch ERP, mapping vendor files to internal SQL schemas and standardizing 565+ product lines to ensure zero-defect financial inputs.
- **Cross-Functional Operations:** Partnered directly with sales, procurement, and distribution teams to evaluate performance against targets, cascading complex pricing matrices, and resolving root-cause POS errors to protect baseline profitability.
- **Executive Strategy:** Pitched formal business cases directly to the VP, securing enterprise buy-in for systemic process improvements.

ADVANCED ANALYTICS & STRATEGIC PROJECTS

- **Geospatial Decision Support System (GDSS):** Architecting a geospatial mapping model to visualize competitive density and isolate localized market friction, allowing leadership to dynamically adjust pricing strategies based on regional saturation.
- **Technical Portfolio:** Engineered a custom repository showcasing enterprise data management, SQL schema mapping, and advanced Python financial modeling.- (austin-stethem.github.io)

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Iowa Lakes CC** — Associate of Arts & Associate of Science
- **W3Schools** — Certified in Data Science & Certified SQL Developer

Emmetsburg, IA
Online